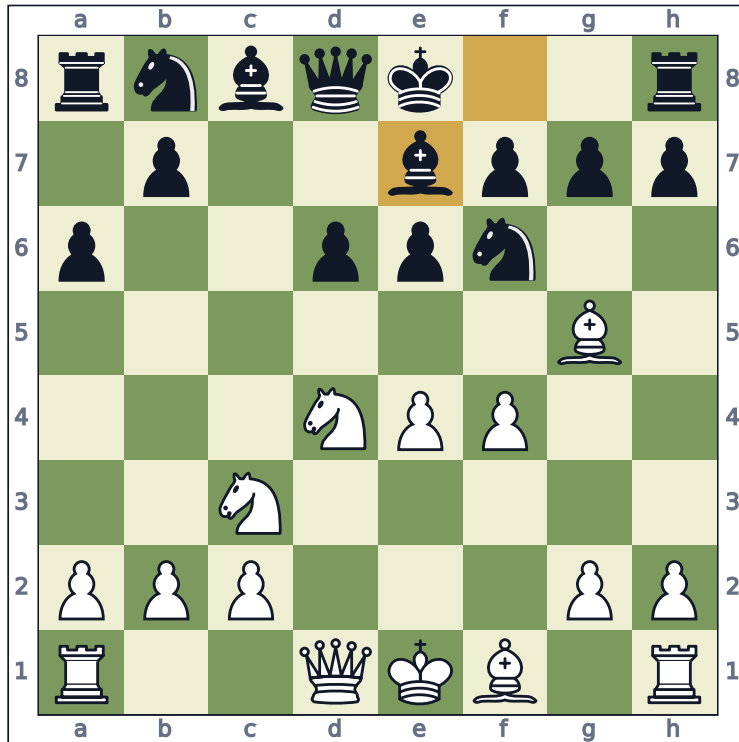


SICILIAN DEFENSE

Sicilian Defense

ECO B98 | 4 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.42 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Unbalanced and ambitious: both sides usually receive active plans and real winning chances.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B98 covers Sicilian Defense. Black answers 1.e4 with ...c5, creating an asymmetrical center and immediate long-term counterplay. The diagram uses the featured line Sicilian Defense: Najdorf Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop rapidly, use d4 when appropriate, exploit central space, and decide whether play belongs on the kingside or in the center.

BLACK'S GOALS

Use the half-open c-file, pressure the center, prepare ...d5 or ...e5, and generate queenside or central counterplay.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...d5 is often Black's equalizing break. White commonly uses e5, f4-f5, or a central sacrifice to open lines.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d5 square, and development race are central. In opposite-side castling, every tempo matters. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Memorized attacks fail when the center or castling pattern differs by one move. Recalculate before launching pawns. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e6, White pawn on f4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A first-rate fighting defense with enormous depth. It is excellent, but specialized variations can be theory-heavy.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B98 line

This section preserves all 4 names and defining routes assigned to B98 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Sicilian Defense: Najdorf Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7

002 Sicilian Defense: Najdorf Variation, Browne Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 h6 9. Bh4 Qc7

003 Sicilian Defense: Najdorf Variation, Goteborg Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 h6 9. Bh4 g5

004 Sicilian Defense: Najdorf Variation, Traditional Line

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 Qc7